

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

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Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

ECONOMY

Federal Reserve Expected to Keep Interest Rates Steady Amid Economic Uncertainty

On July 29, 2026, the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) is expected to announce that it will keep its benchmark interest rate unchanged, maintaining it in the range of 3.50% to 3.75%. This decision comes as the economy shows mixed signals, with some signs of inflation (the general rise in prices of goods and services over time) cooling down, while oil prices

are experiencing renewed shocks. This could affect borrowing costs for consumers and businesses.

For ordinary people, the interest rate set by the Federal Reserve influences the rates they pay on loans, mortgages, and credit cards. Keeping rates steady may provide some stability in borrowing costs, but ongoing economic uncertainties could still impact financial decisions.

Source: Livemint

MARKETS

Rising Oil Prices Could Impact Everyday Costs and Inflation

As of July 28, 2026, rising oil prices are raising concerns about inflation (the general rise in prices of goods and services over time) and the economy. Despite a temporary decrease in oil prices due to a pause in conflicts in the Middle East, prices remain high. This situation could lead to increased costs for consumers, as higher oil prices often translate to higher prices for goods and services.

For ordinary people, this means that they could see higher prices at the gas pump and for everyday items, as businesses often pass on increased costs to consumers. Keeping an eye on oil prices is essential for understanding potential changes in household budgets.

Source: Reuters via Investing.com

Stock Markets on Edge as Investors Await Federal Reserve Decision

On July 29, 2026, global stock markets are experiencing heightened anxiety as investors await the Federal Reserve's decision on interest rates. There is a 26% chance that the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) will increase rates. This uncertainty is compounded by major technology companies, like Meta and Microsoft, preparing to report their earnings, which are influenced by their investments in artificial intelligence (AI).

For everyday people, fluctuations in stock markets can affect retirement savings and investment portfolios. Understanding these developments is essential for making informed financial decisions.

Source: Pomegra News

Tech Giants to Reveal Earnings, Highlighting AI Investments

This week, major technology companies, including Meta, Microsoft, Apple, and Amazon, are set to release their quarterly earnings reports. Investors are particularly interested in understanding how these companies' substantial investments in artificial intelligence (AI) are paying off. With over \$300 billion invested in AI infrastructure, the results of these reports could indicate the profitability and sustainability of these investments.

For everyday people, the performance of these tech giants can influence stock prices and, consequently, the value of retirement accounts and investments. Keeping an eye on these earnings reports is essential for understanding potential impacts on personal finances.

Source: Pomegra News

Investment Banks Predict Surge in AI-Driven Deals

Investment banks are experiencing a boom in deal-making and financing activities, driven by technology companies' rush to fund artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure. Notable transactions include SK Hynix's \$26.5 billion offering and SpaceX's record \$86 billion initial public offering (IPO), which is when a company sells its shares to the public for the first time. This trend is generating significant fees for banks and indicates a shift in the financial landscape.

For everyday people, the rise in AI investments could lead to new job opportunities and innovations that may improve their lives. Understanding these trends can help individuals stay informed about potential changes in the job market and economy.

Source: Reuters via Investing.com

FEATURE

EXPLAINER OF THE DAY

Understanding AI Capital Expenditure in the Tech Industry

AI Capital Expenditure (Capex) refers to the funds that technology companies allocate towards building and enhancing artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure, such as data centers and software development. This concept is currently in the spotlight as major tech firms invest heavily in AI to maintain their competitive advantages. With over \$300 billion in combined AI Capex among leading companies, understanding this investment is crucial for grasping the future of technology and its impact on everyday life.

For ordinary people, these investments can lead to new technologies and services that improve daily life, making it important to stay informed about developments in AI.

Source: Pomegra News